

with its compressed name Regex) helps you create a single goal that can match multiple goals.

Perhaps you have a ‘thank you’ page which has several names. But for you, all leads fall under the same category and are one and the same goal. You can then, in such situations, use Regex to “roll them up”. Regex can also allow you to fine tune your funnel steps in such a way that you can get exactly what you need. But in doing so, do not forget that Regex can be extremely specific. Read on to understand why this specificity is important.

What Are Regular Expressions?

Regular Expressions are all about ‘power matching’. If your task at hand is to create a goal which is capable of matching multiple ‘thank you’ pages, that can be considered power matching. Or if you need a filter which can match multiple URLs in a scenario where you only know a piece of each of these URLs, this will also be considered power matching.

A lot of folks argue that Advanced Segments will let you skip Regex when it comes to GA. This may not be wholly true. While Advanced Segments are a fantastic tool to have in your arsenal, they will never work the way filters do. And if you want to create complicated and extremely interesting goals, you will need Regex (especially if you have a non-GA friendly website designer). Sometimes you may even opt to use Regex in your Advanced Segments.

How Do I Get Started?

You can compare Regex to getting that elusive first job ever in your life. You cannot seem to get hired without the experience, and how do you get the experience without getting hired in the first place? Things are similar in the world of Regex. You cannot really understand them until you use them, and you cannot really use them until you understand them (well, at least a little bit of it at least). So you need to start off with learning a little bit, putting that to the test,



Understanding Regex may be confusing at first. Take your time to practice and you will get there.